

Erich Josef Schwartz

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Citizenship: US

Research interests Economic Development, Political Economy, Experimental Economics, Asian Studies

Education **University of Hawaii- Manoa** Honolulu, HI
PhD in Economics August 2022 – Expected May 2028

Waseda University- Graduate School of Asia-Pacific Studies Tokyo, JP
MA in International Relations September 2020 – September 2022
Advisors: Dr. Atsushi Kato (primary), Dr. Tomoo Kikuchi

George Mason University Fairfax, VA
BS in Economics August 2015 – May 2019
Minors in Chinese Language, Northeast-Asia Pacific Studies
Magna Cum Laude

Honors and scholarships Best 3rd Year Paper Award 2026
Burnham O. Campbell Scholarship 2024-26
Monbukagakusho Scholarship (Japanese MEXT) 2022
Certificate of Merit/GSAPS High Honors List (Waseda GSAPS) 2021
Excellence in Academic Achievement Award (GMU Dept. of Economics) 2019
Excellence in the Chinese Minor (GMU Chinese Program) 2019

Research experience **University of Hawaii Economic Research Organization Graduate Assistant-ship**
Supervisor: Dr. Steven Bond-Smith (UH Manoa/UHERO) May 2025 – Present
Secondary Investigator
Worked with Dr. Bond-Smith to write reports and recommendations to diagnose Hawaii's economic situation, with a focus on adjusting Hawaii's income statistics for local prices and examining slower than average growth rates. Performed statistical analysis, wrote and edited reports, created graphics/charts/tables, etc.

Chinese Cultural Revolution Violence and Individual Career Choice
October 2025–Present
Sole Investigator

Second dissertation chapter examining the long-term effects of Cultural Revolution violence on career choice in China using China Family Panel Survey Data. Presented at Western Economic Association International Conference, Bangkok, Thailand, April 2026.

Chinese Development Finance and Host Country Democracy March 2024–Present

Sole Investigator

First dissertation chapter, is an analysis of Belt and Road Initiative effects on democratic institutions in recipient countries. Presented at Western Economic Association San Francisco Conference, June 2025.

Estimating the Economic Need and Environmental Impact of Investments in Natural Gas Pipeline Infrastructure

Mentor: Dr. Michael Roberts (UH Manoa)

June 2023 – June 2024

Secondary Investigator

Used SWITCH modelling to determine optimal level of natural gas infrastructure investment needs with endogenous price and supply and demand response. Provided assistance with data cleaning and preparation to run in the model, literature review etc.

Waseda Institute of Digital Government

Mentors: Dr. Toshio Obi (Waseda University- Emeritus), Dr. Naoko Iwasaki (Waseda University)

September 2021 – July 2022

Secondary Investigator

Researched and edited the Waseda International Digital Government Rankings 2021. Researched publications on digital governance, ICT and other emerging technologies. Provided policy suggestions for reports. Researched and wrote a report on bilateral investment between the US and Indonesia/Vietnam. Assisted with conferences and events put on by the Institute.

Teaching experience

Instructor , Department of Economics (UH Manoa)

ECON 442: Development Economics

Theoretical foundation and empirical evidence for analyzing key issues facing today's developing world. Topics include characteristics of underdeveloped economies, economic growth, structural change, poverty, inequality, education, population growth, foreign aid and financial sector.

Taught: SU25, SU26, SP27

ECON 416: Chinese Economy

Explores the Chinese economy during the imperial and republican periods, under Mao, and into the present reform era, with a brief comparison to Taiwan and Hong Kong. Covers topics such as the economic history of China from the ancient dynasties to the People's Republic, the Great Leap Forward, the Cultural Revolution, and the economic reforms of the late 20th century. Includes contemporary issues such as China's role in the global economy, the so-called "China Shock," Chinese development strategy, and its political economy.

Taught: SU26

PhD Math Camp

Preparatory course for incoming PhD students covering the mathematical foundations needed for first-year graduate coursework in economics.

Taught: SU26

ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomics

Develops basic techniques and fundamental concepts of microeconomic theory. Learn to use economic reasoning to understand the social consequences of decisions made by individual consumers, producers, and governments. Analyze the nature of market outcomes under alternative market structures, and further discuss possible welfare-improving government policies when markets fail to be efficient. Special attention is paid to the analysis of strategic behavior and markets with public goods and externalities.

Taught: SU25

ECON 256: Data Analysis and Visualization

Designed to help develop basic techniques of data analysis and visualization. Introduces sources of economic data; methods of preparing data from various file/data formats for analysis; methods of visualization: bubble plots, scatter-plot matrices, heatmaps, hexbins, rug plots, etc.

Taught: SU24